

Operations Section Chief Position Checklist

The following checklist should be considered as the minimum requirements for this position. Note that some of the tasks are one-time actions; others are ongoing or repetitive for the duration of the incident.



Task

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1. Obtain briefing from Incident Commander:

- Determine incident objectives and recommended strategies.
- Determine status of current tactical assignments.
- Identify current organization, location of resources, and assignments.
- Confirm resource ordering process.
- Determine location of current Staging Areas and resources assigned there.

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2. Organize Operations Section to ensure operational efficiency, personnel safety and adequate span of control.

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3. Establish operational period.

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4. Establish and demobilize Staging Areas.

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5. Attend Operations Briefing and assign Operations personnel in accordance with Incident Action Plan (IAP):

- Brief Staging Area Manager on types and numbers of resources to be maintained in Staging.
- Brief tactical elements (Branches, Divisions/Groups, Task Force/Strike-Team Leaders) on assignments, ordering process, protective equipment, and tactical assignments.

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6. Develop and manage tactical operations to meet incident objectives.

Operations Section Chief Position Checklist

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7. Assess life safety:

- Adjust perimeters, as necessary, to ensure scene security.
- Evaluate and enforce use of appropriate protective clothing and equipment.
- Implement and enforce appropriate safety precautions.

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8. Evaluate situation and provide update to Planning Section:

- Location, status, and assignment of resources.
- Effectiveness of tactics.
- Desired contingency plans.

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9. Determine need and request additional resources.

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10. Notify Resources Unit of Section Branches, Divisions/Groups, Strike Teams/Task Forces, and single resources which are staffed, including location of resources and names of leaders.

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11. Keep Resources Unit up to date on changes in resource status.

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12. Write formal Operations portion of IAP with the Planning Section Chief, if so directed by the Incident Commander:

- Identify assignments by Division or Group.
- Identify specific tactical assignments.
- Identify resources needed to accomplish assignments.

Operations Section Chief Position Checklist

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13. Ensure coordination of the Operations Section with other Command and General Staff:

- Ensure Operations Section time-keeping, activity logs, and equipment use documents are maintained and passed to Planning, Logistics, and Finance/Administration Sections, as appropriate.
- Ensure resource ordering and logistical support needs are passed to Logistics in a timely fashion-enforce ordering process.
- Notify Logistics of communications problems.
- Keep Planning up-to-date on resource and situation status.
- Notify Liaison Officer of issues concerning cooperating and assisting agency resources.
- Keep Safety Officer involved in tactical decision-making.
- Keep Incident Commander apprised of status of operational efforts.
- Coordinate media field visits with the Public Information Officer.

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14. Attend the Tactics Meeting with Planning Section Chief, Safety Officer, and Incident Commander prior to the Planning Meeting to review strategy, discuss tactics, and outline organization assignments.

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15. Attend Planning Meetings:

Sample Planning Meeting Agenda

Agenda Item	Responsible Party
1 Briefing on situation/resource status.	Planning/Operations Section Chiefs
2 Discuss safety issues.	Safety Officer
3 Set/confirm incident objectives.	Incident Commander
4 Plot control lines & Division boundaries.	Operations Section Chief
5 Specify tactics for each Division/Group.	Operations Section Chief
6 Specify resources needed for each Division/Group.	Operations/Planning Section Chiefs
7 Specify facilities and reporting locations.	Operations/Planning/Logistics Section Chiefs
8 Develop resource order.	Logistics Section Chief
9 Consider communications/medical/transportation plans.	Logistics/Planning Section Chiefs
10 Provide financial update.	Finance/Administration Section Chief
11 Discuss interagency liaison issues.	Liaison Officer
12 Discuss information issues.	Public Information Officer
13 Finalize/approve/implement plan.	Incident Commander/All

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16. Hold Section meetings, as necessary, to ensure communication and coordination among Operations Branches, Divisions, and Groups.